
**Unit 1, Option B,
Topic B7: Crown,
Conflict and
Revolution in
England, 1660-89**

The main focus of this topic is the development of constitutional monarchy in England and the role of political and religious conflict in this process. Since the focus of this unit is on broad themes, questions will not be set which focus exclusively on depth of knowledge, for example about one particular individual or event, other than those which are specifically listed in the content bullet points. Students will, however, be expected to demonstrate their understanding of the themes defined in the content bullet points by the selection and deployment of relevant information as exemplification.

The bullet points should not each be considered in isolation. Collectively, they define key themes the changing nature of monarchy, the impact of developments in religion, the economy and foreign relations, the role of individuals and their effect on the relationship between Crown and Parliament. Questions will therefore draw on more than one bullet point and on students' understanding of these issues and the interaction between them.

The first bullet point relates to the nature of the Restoration settlement and the role and powers of the monarch, which were largely defined in 1660-62, and the role of the Church. Students should understand the main features of the settlement, the process by which it took shape and the impact of further changes in 1664-67. The key focus of this bullet point is on the nature of the restored monarchy, the extent of its powers and its relationship to other institutions in government. Students are not expected to have detailed knowledge of events before 1660. However, an understanding of the situation in 1659 and the circumstances in which the Restoration took place is relevant to the topic's main features.

The second bullet point relates to Charles II's relations with his ministers, Parliament and the reasons for the conflicts listed in the bullet point, and how these conflicts influenced the powers of the crown in practice. The role of Charles, his personality and his ability to handle difficult political situations is significant, but students can also consider the aims and impact of other political figures such as Clarendon, the Cabal and the Whig leadership. Students should consider the interaction of religious and political issues and the impact of foreign affairs, for example relations with France and the nature of Louis XIV's influence, but they are not expected to have detailed knowledge of events in Europe at this time.

The third bullet point relates to economic conflict and the origins of empire. Students should be aware of the expansion and diversification of overseas trade and its impact on relations with other powers. They should understand why the Anglo-Dutch wars of 1664-67 and 1672-74 occurred. Students are not expected to have detailed knowledge of conflicts, but they should understand the problems caused by the need to finance the wars and appreciate the significance of the outcomes of the conflicts.

The fourth bullet point, relates to the attitudes and personality of James as Duke of York and King, the impact of his actions and policies, and the reasons for his flight and 'abdication' in 1688. Students should understand that the strong position which James inherited was gradually undermined by his religious views and the links perceived to exist between Catholicism and Absolutism, and by his impatience and lack of judgement, exemplified by his attack on the Church of England. They should also understand the implications of the birth of his son. The role of William of Orange and the wider context of European conflict are relevant but students they are not expected to have detailed knowledge of European affairs. They should be aware of the main features of the 1689 settlement.